

A FINAL REPORT ON

**Outreach Automation and Participant Acquisition for UN-Certified
Programmes at Ureka Education Group**

BY

YUVAN KARTHIK G

2022A7PS0258U

AT

**UREKA EDUCATION GROUP
DUBAI, UAE**

A Practice School – II Station of



**BITS Pilani, Dubai Campus
Dubai International Academic City, Dubai
UAE**

(January 2026 – July 2026)

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Key Words: Business Development, Email Outreach, CSR Sponsorship, University Partnerships, UN Programmes, Ethical Fashion, AI for Social Impact

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Abstract (Max 200 words): The following report is a complete record of my internship at Ureka Education Group, Dubai from February to July 2026, that took place as part of Practice School-II. The internship included the following UN related programmes: UN AI for Social Impact programme, UN Ethical Fashion Immersion (EFI) Milan 2026, and the newly created global AI and fashion internship developed by Ureka in collaboration with UNITAR. A CSR company database, with more than 1,000 companies, was built in seven major markets, and more than 200 personalised outreach emails were sent, resulting in positive responses and discovery calls with CSR companies such as Capgemini, Schaeffler and Pearson. Followed by a university outreach in June 2026, more than 30 institutional responses were received within one week. In the Ethical Fashion Immersion and WOVEN, some 3000 universities around the world were surveyed and 1500+ customised e-mails were sent out, every day resulting in 43 responses by the universities, fashion companies and students themselves. This meant that using the Python automation system, roughly 500 personalised emails were sent per day, including batch rate-limit, multi-account round-robin, dynamic placeholder replacement, and CSV status tracking. In all projects, 77 institutional and individual responses were recorded from institutions from the USA, UK, Europe, Asia and the MENA region.



Signature of Student

Date: 28/06/2026

Signature of PS Faculty

Date:

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(Yuvan Karthik G)

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CHAPTER 1: OVERVIEW OF UREKA EDUCATION GROUP

1.1 Introduction

Ureka Education Group is an international education and experiential learning group established in London, United Kingdom in 2014. A Sloan Fellows group from London Business School has been formed and is led by a professor who was a Sloan Fellow at INSEAD, one of the world's top business schools. This intellectual heritage underlies the organization's philosophy of utilizing rigorous conceptual frameworks and experiential, immersive learning opportunities for students and young professionals from around the world.

Ureka's goal is to connect the disciplines of academic learning with the fast-changing job market in the world. It does this through a wide range of programmes, such as virtual internships, global immersions, semester abroad programmes and United Nations recognised programmes in over two dozen subject areas such as Artificial Intelligence, Fashion, Healthcare, Architecture, Law, Finance and Sustainability.

Ureka Education Group has established a significant presence in an international market, with offices and operational centres strategically located in various geographies: This is the primary headquarters of the group, located in the UK. The Main European headquarters is in Oxford, United Kingdom.

Dubai, UAE - Regional hub of the IMEA (India, Middle East and Africa) region where this internship took place. EU programme operations in Lyon, France.

Social Entrepreneurship Centre, India – Specialised in Social Impact and Entrepreneurship programs.

Research Institute, France – Academic research and programme development

It allows Ureka to cater for a diverse population of students from around the world and remain regionally attuned to the needs of its students when planning programmes and targeting outreach.

1.2 Partnership with UNITAR

One of the unique characteristics of Ureka's flagship programmes is its official collaboration with United Nations Institute for Training and Research (UNITAR). The partnership enables Ureka to provide UN certified programmes, adding much international prestige to its programmes. Upon completion of Ureka's UN-certified programmes, students are awarded a certificate recognized worldwide by the United Nations (UN) body, UNITAR. This UN affiliation will also allow Ureka to organize programme sessions at United Nations premises, such as the UN Headquarters in Geneva, Switzerland which is one of the highlights of the AI for Social Impact programme.

1.3 Market Position and Scale

Ureka Education Group is a one of the bigger experiential learning providers in the IMEA region. Students from universities all over Europe, Asia, the Middle East and the Americas flock to its programmes. Ureka's unique place in the international premium education market is achieved thanks to the credibility of UN certification, world class speakers, including the Nobel Laureates, senior UN officials, and in-person tours to global cities like Geneva and Milan.

1.4 Internship Context

This internship was successfully completed at the Dubai office of Ureka Education Group from 03 February 2026 till 10 July 2026 at BITS Pilani Practice School-II. I was placed under the Business Development and Outreach function where the main mandate is acquisition of participants in various programmes under the auspices of the UN. During my internship, three different projects were implemented: (i) the UN AI for Social Impact programme (Geneva) (ii) the UN Ethical Fashion Immersion - Milan 2026 and (iii) the new global project: WOVEN - AI and fashion exchange internship. The internship also involved the design and deployment of an email automation system written in Python, which would be used to make outreach more scalable than it would be if it were done manually.

CHAPTER 2: UN AI FOR SOCIAL IMPACT

2.1 Programme Overview

The UN AI for Social Impact programme is a flagship programme of Ureka Education Group in collaboration with UNITAR. It's an immersive experience that takes place in Geneva, Switzerland, for three days at the UN Headquarters. The programme's aims are to provide to the university students and young professionals the knowledge, mindset and skills to function in a professional world dominated by AI while maintaining social responsibility and ethical awareness.

The course's content consists of AI ethics, responsible development of technology, AI's contributions to global development issues, and practical models for creating AI solutions that have a positive impact on society. The participants meet with UN representatives, Nobel Laureates, former heads of state and high-ranking leaders from the industry. At the end, all participants will be awarded a certificate, the official UNITAR certificate, which is a recognized UN certificate.

2.2 The CSR Sponsorship Model

To set up a CSR Sponsorship Model, the following actions are required:

The AI for Social Impact programme is not a business-to-consumer (B2C) programme, but rather a Business-to-Business (B2B) corporate sponsorship model. The strategy is aimed at corporations that have an active Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) mandate, offering the possibility for them to sponsor student participation under their CSR budgets in programmes, costing between 100 and 500 students per corporate partner.

This is a simple logic: businesses that do have corporate social responsibility (CSR) programs are expected to invest in youth development, education and future-skills programs. Supporting students' participation in a UN certified AI programme in Geneva is a high-impact, high-profile and socially impactful CSR investment with direct markings of the United Nations and measurable ESG reporting benefits. This approach proved to be successful when it came to obtaining discovery calls with big companies even from cold outreach.

2.3 Phase 1: Corporate CSR Outreach (February 2026)

2.3.1 Building the CSR Target Database

Building the CSR Target Database is a process that builds the target database for CSR.

The first step was to identify systematically the companies that have active CSR programmes in line with the themes of the programme: education, technology, sustainability and youth empowerment. A large database of more than 1,000 companies was created, with a primary focus on the seven countries that spend the most on corporate social responsibility (CSR) in the world: the United States, the United Kingdom, Germany, Japan, China, France and India, with the remainder of the world's companies included. CSR Heads, Sustainability Directors and Corporate Affairs Managers were chosen as key decision-maker contacts for each company.

Table 2.1: CSR Company Database – Country Distribution

Country	No. of Companies	Key Sectors Targeted
USA	300	Technology, Finance, Consulting, Retail
UK	150	Finance, Consulting, Energy, Education
Germany	130	Automotive, Engineering, Manufacturing
Japan	120	Electronics, Automotive, Finance
China	100	Manufacturing, Technology, State Enterprises
France	80	Luxury, Energy, Financial Services
India	80	IT, FMCG, Banking, Manufacturing
Rest of World	50+	Energy, Mining, Finance, Retail
Total	1,000+	--

Note: Rest of World includes UAE, Australia, Canada, Singapore, Netherlands, and others.

2.3.2 Personalised Email Outreach

One of the key aspects of the outreach approach was the level of personalisation achieved. Each e-mail contained a tailored paragraph that directly mentioned the stated goals of the recipient company's CSR initiatives, ESG commitments, or published sustainability reports, and how sponsoring student participation was directly relevant to their goals. In February 2026, 200 of these customised emails were sent from the company's database of 1,000+ contacts. One of the catchy subject lines was followed by a Programme overview, a paragraph tailored to make CSR's personal connection, and finally a call to action for a discovery call.

2.3.3 Developing Outreach Collateral

Along with the email campaign, the following sales and outreach materials were created:

- A 1-Pager PDF to be distributed to corporate decision makers: Describes the programme in a nutshell, with details on the UN affiliation, main results, and speakers and benefits of sponsorship.
- Objection Handling Framework: Structured document that includes common objections in the corporate world such as ROI questions and CSR reporting alignment concerns, and provides evidence-based responses for those objections.
- Multi-Touch Email Sequence - A three-step outreach strategy starting with the initial email, followed by a follow-up (sent if not responded to within the first 5-7 days) and a third follow-up to ensure that maximum response is achieved without being intrusive.

2.4 Phase 2: University Outreach (June 2026)

The last two weeks of my internship, the emphasis of the AI for Social Impact project changed from CSR of companies to an outreach of the university. The email automation system, which was described extensively in Chapter 5, was utilized to reach out to decision makers at universities around the world, who were provided by Ms Rand, with individual follow-up emails introducing the AI for Social Impact programme as an endorsement of the UN.

The outreach focused on a variety of large research universities but also included a number of smaller liberal arts institutions in the United States, United Kingdom, India, and mainland Europe. The volume and speed the automation system provided reduced what could have been weeks of manual work to a matter of days. More than 30 institutional responses were received within a week of the outreach, highlighting the quality of the contact data base and the efficiency of the automation pipeline.

Table 2.2: AIFSI University Outreach Response Tracker (June 2026)

Institution / Contact	Country	Date
Sandy Hirsh, San José State University	USA	18 Jun 2026
Irma Becerra, Marymount University	USA	19 Jun 2026
Cynthia Matson, San José State University	USA	19 Jun 2026
Andrew Rich, Franklin & Marshall College	USA	19 Jun 2026
Art Malloy, North Dakota University System	USA	19 Jun 2026
L. Ajayi, Northeastern University	USA	19 Jun 2026
J. Lee, Franklin & Marshall College	USA	19 Jun 2026

Institution / Contact	Country	Date
Pro-Vice Chancellor, DSU	India	19 Jun 2026
Contact, Duke University	USA	22 Jun 2026
Bruno V., Corvinus University of Budapest	Hungary	23 Jun 2026
Skoumantakis, Metropolitan University Athens	Greece	23 Jun 2026
David Goatley, Fuller Theological Seminary	USA	23 Jun 2026
Shaaban Abdallah, University of Cincinnati	USA	23 Jun 2026
N. Karodia, Edinburgh Napier University	UK	23 Jun 2026
Principal, JDM College (Delhi University)	India	23 Jun 2026
Prof. R.K. Suresh (Academic)	India	23 Jun 2026
S. Malas, Cyprus Institute	Cyprus	24 Jun 2026
A. Chow, San José State University	USA	24 Jun 2026
Contact, Duke University	USA	24 Jun 2026
Principal, HKCE	India	24 Jun 2026
Ivana Gjorgievska, ESMT Berlin	Germany	24 Jun 2026
CS Placements, University of York	UK	25 Jun 2026
Sagar Gulati, Jain University	India	25 Jun 2026
CS Department, University of Iowa	USA	25 Jun 2026
Janice Shaw, University of Florida	USA	26 Jun 2026
EPMS School, Royal Holloway University	UK	26 Jun 2026
IQAC Office, KBPCOES	India	26 Jun 2026

2.5 Results and Outcomes

In both phases of the AI for Social Impact project the following outcomes were achieved:

Phase 1 (Corporate CSR, February 2026): More than 1000 companies researched and added to the outreach database; 200 personalised outreach emails sent; three major positive responses received from Capgemini, Schaeffler and Pearson; discovery calls booked and successfully completed with all three companies; full programme proposals presented targeting 100-500 sponsored students per partner; complete outreach collateral suite developed.

Phase 2 (University Outreach, June 2026): 30+ institutional responses were received from universities in the USA, UK, India, Germany, Hungary, Greece and Cyprus within a single week.

Tracked entries from combined AIFSI responses across both phases: 34 tracked entries as well as the four corporate responses originally sent out in the outreach campaign (Emirates NBD, GlobalLogic, Pearson, Capgemini).

2.6 Key Learnings

The AI for Social Impact project has offered initial exposure to B2B business development, such as generating leads at scale, crafting personalised email copy, awareness of CSR and ESG reporting frameworks, creation of sales collateral and pipeline management. The Phase 2 university outreach also showed off, in real life, how an automated outreach system could dramatically shorten the time it takes to produce a campaign: in one week, 30+ institutional responses are generated, as opposed to what would take several weeks by manually doing the work.

CHAPTER 3: UN ETHICAL FASHION IMMERSION, MILAN

3.1 Programme Overview

The UN Ethical Fashion Immersion – Milan 2026 is an international programme, certified by the UN, created by Ureka Education Group in collaboration with UNITAR and Ferrari Fashion School in Milan. It offers a holistic and transdisciplinary learning experience for university students around the themes of fashion, sustainability, ethics and global cultural diplomacy.

There are two stages to the programme. In Phase 1, participants undertake an online three-week course (25 to 14 May 2026) that leads to the awarding of a UNITAR certification on global governance, human rights, sustainable development and cultural diplomacy as understood by the fashion industry. The one-week in-person experience (15–19 June 2026) in Phase 2 will feature visits to artisan ateliers, sessions in the textile innovation lab, a lecture on the concept of slow fashion and circular economy models, a session with the UNITAR Director and a capstone project showcase. The programme fee is €1,920 and a UNITAR certificate will be issued to all participants at the end of the programme.

3.2 Programme Pillars

The programme is grounded in three central elements, which underpin the programme curriculum and positioning it in the outreach arena:

- Ethical Fashion Practices: Fair labour, clear supply chains and human rights issues throughout the product life cycle.
- Sustainability Innovation: Sustainable sourcing of materials, circular economy business models, upcycling and zero waste design strategies.
- Fashion as a means of cultural diplomacy: understanding how fashion works as a cultural medium that facilitates interculturalism, soft power and global identity building.

3.3 My Role: University Outreach and Participant Recruitment

My job was to facilitate the recruitment of participants by formalizing partnerships with universities around the world and transform them into enrolled students participating in the Milan 2026 programme. This included researching and mapping the target universities globally, developing outreach strategies with a personalised approach per region, arranging and conducting discovery calls with interested universities, establishing a structured pipeline database and creating innovative outreach channels to complement direct outreach to universities.

3.4 Methodology: University Outreach Strategy

3.4.1 Initial University Mapping (February 2026)

The initial University mapping process for Phase 1 began in February 2026. Phase 1 initial University mapping began in February 2026. It started with universities in the UAE and selected European fashion schools, before being extended to a larger group of universities around the world. The key decision makers in each institution were identified using in-depth research of the heads of the International Office, Study Abroad Coordinator, the Chair of the Fashion Department and the Student Affairs Officer for each institution. This first step was the foundation that was then expanded to a worldwide database of some 3,000 universities.

3.4.2 Global Expansion and Region-Specific Outreach (March 2026)

This is the second phase of the project, which is expected to take place in March 2026 and will include further expansion into the global market and outreach activities in Europe and the Middle East. This database was dramatically extended in March 2026 to include fashion schools and design institutes from four continents, making a total of around 3,000 universities. Over this period and up to April, approximately 1,500 personalised outreach e-mails were sent world-wide. The main improvements made in this stage were:

Geographical, institutional and programme-specific messages: Each email was designed according to the institution's geographical, institutional and programme-specific context, and not with a generic template.

Portuguese-language email variants: A complete Portuguese version of the outreach email was created and sent to the universities in South America, resulting in a significant increase in the engagement seen in that region.

Outreach to decision makers: Emails were sent directly to decision makers instead of departmental inbox which helped with higher open and response rates.

The entire “Ethical Fashion” programme brochure was finalized, as well as content for the student recruitment website landing page and a detailed FAQ section were developed.

3.4.3 Live Engagement and New Outreach Channels (April 2026)

The next phase (Phase 3) will commence in April 2026 following the cohort, where we will commence live engagement on the new outreach channels.

The engagement with potential University partners increased significantly in April 2026. A daily e-mail campaign was launched to the new and follow-up university contacts where KPIs were tracked and reported weekly to Ms. Rand and to the CEO. A new approach was created for the acquisition of new participants: Fashion unions and Industry associations around the world as other referral and awareness sources. After a positive email exchange with ESA Business School (Beirut), a discovery call was held on 15 April 2026 and a call with Belas Artes São Paulo was booked afterwards. Ashoka University also just booked a discovery call for 6 April 2026.

3.5 Results Achieved

During the entire EFI outreach program, a total of 43 responses were received from universities, fashion schools and individual contacts from all over the world. The key responses that were received from universities and institutions are summarized in the table below:

Table 3.1: EFI University Outreach – Response Tracker

Institution	Country	Status / Response
ESA Business School	Lebanon	Positive – discovery call completed (15 Apr 2026)
Ashoka University	India	Positive – discovery call booked (6 Apr 2026)
Krea University	India	Positive – expressed interest; further follow-up planned
Centro Belas Artes de São Paulo	Brazil	Referred to International Office for discussion
Nat. Inst. of Fashion Technology Delhi	India	Requested further information about the programme
Istituto Secoli	Italy	Requested further communication materials
University of São Paulo (USP)	Brazil	Forwarded to arts department
Heriot-Watt School of Textiles	UK	Forwarded to the School of Textiles
Ravensbourne University London	UK	Referred to dedicated industry partnerships team
Chelsea College of Arts (UAL)	UK	Referred to Creative Opportunities platform
RUFA – Rome University of Fine Arts	Italy	Responded; pipeline progressing
Antwerp Royal Academy of Fine Arts	Belgium	Declined – programme fee and dates cited
University of Technology Sydney	Australia	Declined – policy against fee-based promotions
V.N. Karazin Kharkiv National University	Ukraine	Declined – ongoing conflict situation cited
Universitas Multimedia Nusantara	Indonesia	Declined – geopolitical constraints cited
Universidade Católica Portuguesa	Portugal	Wrong contact; referred elsewhere
Instituto Sendtko de Ensino Superior	Brazil	Declined – no fashion programme offered
Additional respondents (various)	Multiple	Neutral or positive; follow-up in progress

3.6 Key Learnings

The most comprehensive outreach experience of the internship was the EFI project, which included an outreach programme in more than 3,000 institutions across the four continents. There were some important lessons to be learned. The emails that mentioned specific faculty programmes, sustainability initiatives and context of the region of the fashion industry showed significantly more engagement than more generic versions. Declined responses were beneficial, too – the substantive concerns from institutions such as Antwerp (campaign fee) and UTS (policy constraints) were providing information that was relevant, actionable and market clear for the designs of future campaigns. The higher the response rate, the more strongly the Portuguese-language variant of institutions was associated among South Americas and the lower the response rate, the lower the association among North Americas.

CHAPTER 4: WOVEN GLOBAL AI FASHION INTERNSHIP

4.1 Programme Overview

A fully online eight-week international internship programme, developed by Ureka in official partnership with UNITAR, is called WOVEN. A new addition in Ureka's programme portfolio, WOVEN will be centered on crosscultural team working in the fashion industry, with participants from various countries working together to create creative and ethical fashion pieces aligned to the SDGs. WOVEN, the name itself is an acronym: Worldwide Cultural Exchange, Online and Accessible, Values-Driven Innovation, Ethical Fashion Leadership, and Next Generation of Global Changemakers.

WOVEN has four phases of structure. The first phase is the UNITAR AI for Social Impact online course (which is attended by the participants and where they receive an official UNITAR certificate upon completion). Phase 2 is an individual ethical fashion challenge. Phase 3 consists of a four-week virtual internship in a genuine SDG fashion brief with a Lead Supervisor and a multi-lateral group of 5 to 8 interns from a variety of countries. Phase 4 is a Virtual Global Fashion Expo in which teams can present their work and the first-place team receives USD 1,500 and the winning team will take an all expenses paid trip to the United Nations in Geneva. The fee for the programme is USD 850, and it is available to students from all academic fields around the world.

4.2 Strategy for outreach is developed for WOVEN

WOVEN outreach was designed under three different channels with different target groups for potential participants and partners. The mix of these channels was a result of both the positioning of the programme and its overall mission to diversify the acquisition model, as well as its accessibility, online nature, and lower cost compared to EFI.

4.2.1 University Re-Engagement Campaign

The most obvious approach was to renew the pipeline of universities already reached out to for the Ethical Fashion Immersion. WOVEN was fully online as well as significantly more convenient than the in-person EFI (at €1,920), directly addressing two of the most common objections raised at EFI outreach – cost and logistics. Follow-up emails were sent to universities that didn't respond to EFI outreach or expressed interest without converting/repositioning WOVEN as a complementary & accessible entry point into the Ureka's Fashion Education Ecosystem. This re-engagement campaign was successfully implemented at scale in order to get through the full pipeline in the university effectively.

4.2.2 CSR Outreach with Fashion Brands

Another outreach channel was established for reaching out to fashion brands and industry corporations which have CSR programmes and suggests that they sponsor the WoVEN participation of students or employees. This was an adaptation of the CSR sponsorship model already used for the AI for Social Impact programme, and it was applied to the context of fashion sustainability, ethical supply chains and youth development, all of which are key brand priorities.

Table 4.1: WOVEN Fashion Brand CSR Outreach – Response Tracker

Brand / Organisation	Country	Response
Al Zain Jewellery	Kuwait	Positive – discovery call requested
Delta Galil	Israel	Positive – discovery call requested
MASCO Group	Bangladesh	Interested – requested programme details
Hirdaramani Bangladesh	Bangladesh	Under internal review
Bitopi Group	Bangladesh	Forwarded to relevant manager
Gucci	Italy	Forwarded to CSR department contact
Sandstorm Kenya	Kenya	Forwarded to manager for review
Textile Exchange	USA	Will revisit if budget permits
The Green Way	India	Will review for alignment
Brunello Cucinelli	Italy	Declined – existing commitments cited
Ralph Lauren	USA	Declined – capacity constraints cited
Burberry	UK	Declined – not the right fit at this time
Rolex	Switzerland	Declined after consideration
Swarovski (two contacts)	Austria	Declined – not the right department
Beeline Group	Germany	Declined – has own talent programmes
The Walt Disney Company	USA	Declined after consideration
Messe Düsseldorf	Germany	Declined – budget constraints
Maui Jim	USA	Declined
Tchibo Praha	Czech Rep.	Declined – not of interest at this time

4.2.3 Individual Student Direct Outreach

Another channel investigated in the WOVEN outreach was the direct, one-to-one contact with students in the field of fashion and emerging fashion professionals who were personally at risk of being interested in the programme. This was a conscious shift from the institutional B2B to the individual B2C model which had not been adopted in previous internship phases and which is closely aligned with WOVEN's positioning as a non-institutional model, accessible to individuals through enrolment.

Table 4.2: WOVEN Individual Student Direct Outreach

Contact	Profile	Institution / Background
Theksshith VMJ	Fashion student	National Institute of Fashion Technology (NIFT)
Aleksiiia Pogrebniak	Near-graduating student	Fashion / design background
Isha Jatav	Entry-level professional	Fashion industry
Fionn Kee Wenxi	Student	Fashion / creative discipline
Jiayao Xie	Student	Fashion / creative discipline

4.3 Results and Outcomes

WOVEN outreach efforts resulted in 24 individual responses from 3 channels. Two positive call requests were obtained from fashion brands: Al Zain Jewellery & Delta Galil. Several other brands submitted a soft pipeline report of the proposal internally or noted that it would be considered. Five student contacts were located and approached through student outreach. The university re-engagement campaign added to the existing EFI pipeline, ensuring the opportunity for WOVEN remained a visible one to institutions that had previously engaged but not converted.

4.4 Key Learnings

WOVEN was a new outreach challenge in many ways from the previous projects. WOVEN was a new programme that was pitched to audiences in parallel with more established programmes such as EFI or AIFSI, which had already built institutional credibility and had a defined model of a university partner. The positioning had to be done carefully – the UNITAR credential was the first, followed by noting the zero logistics accessibility of the UNITAR courses (no travel, no visa required), and then adjusting the pitch according to the listener (institutions, corporations or individual students). It also was very educational to simultaneously run B2B (corporate CSR) and B2C (individual student) outreach during the same campaign. It was crucial that the messaging in the two channels is very different, the tone is different, the call to action shape is different, and the structure too is different.

CHAPTER 5: EMAIL OUTREACH AUTOMATION SYSTEM

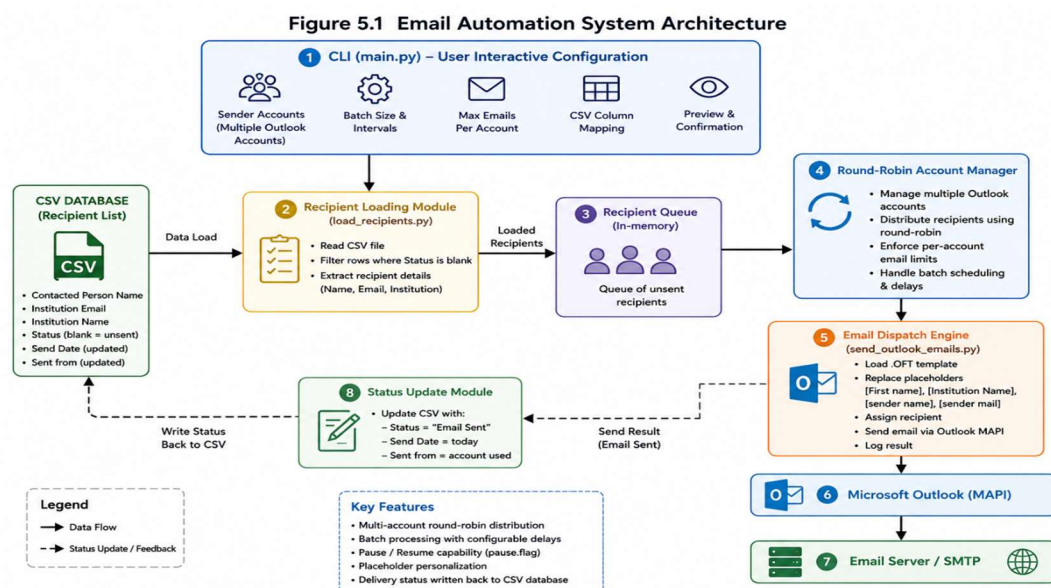
5.1 Background and Motivation

In the first half of my internship project I participated in, we adopted a fully manual outreach model. All outreach emails were drafted individually on the Outlook platform, customized, and sent one by one. This model produced accurate, high-quality communication content. However, when EFI's full-scale outreach launched, which required coverage of thousands of higher education institutions across multiple global regions, the manual mode not only failed to meet the required daily output target, but also easily led to problems such as duplicate email sends and errors in tracking outreach status. These risks worsened continuously as the operation scale expanded, laying out sufficient justification for upgrading the original working model.

One particular requirement influenced the solution: the outreach needed to remain from corporate Ureka email addresses using Microsoft Outlook, not a third-party email marketing solution. An email sent from a trusted corporate domain performs drastically better than an email sent through a bulk sender, and Ureka's relationships with university and corporate contacts relied on that deliverability and authenticity. Any automation solution would have to fit into that Outlook-based environment. Thus, a bespoke email sending tool was developed in-house in Python, which interacts directly with Outlook using its COM automation interface, allowing sending to be automated programmatically at scale, while retaining the deliverability benefits of being sent from a genuine corporate account.

5.2 System Architecture Overview

The system consists of three Python modules that form a pipeline. The first takes a CSV contact database as input, reads it and filters it to produce a queue of recipients to be emailed. The second module calls out to Outlook to send each recipient a personalized, templated email, and then writes the status back to the CSV. The third module is an interactive command-line interface which combines the first two, handles configuration, and produces a pre-send preview for quality control. Figure 5.1 below gives an overview of the system architecture.



The system uses CLI Microsoft Outlook .oft template files as the unit of mail content. These files hold the entire, HTML formatted body of the message including inline formatting, signature blocks, and corporate branding. Tokens are placed within the body and values are swapped in at send time. This was a very conscious decision: we wanted the email template to be isolated from the automation Python script. This way non-programmers at Ureka could change the mail content without having to modify the Python code.

5.3 Core Components

5.3.1 Recipient Loading Module (*load_recipients.py*)

The Recipient loading module takes the list of contacts to send out to from a CSV file. The filtering that this module employs is very conservative, only including rows with completely empty Status columns to ensure that someone will never be emailed twice by running the system over the same database multiple times.

The recipient loader also ceases to gather data from the spreadsheet after reaching a row with an empty name field, which acts as a natural end-of-data marker in our Ureka outreach spreadsheets. The module is written to be configurable: the column names for the recipient's full name, email address, status, and institution are all passed in as parameters, rather than hard-coded in the module.

The same module can thus be used for CSV files with different layouts without any code changes. This became important over time as different campaigns using the software ended up with slightly different spreadsheet formats. In addition to CSV, the module also has functions to load recipients from a SQLite database, or an Excel spreadsheet, making it trivial to plug the system into different data management workflows.

5.3.2 Email Dispatch Engine (*send_outlook_emails.py*)

The email dispatch engine is at the heart of the system. It accesses Microsoft Outlook via the win32com Python library, which exposes Outlook's Component Object Model (COM) automation interface. This requires Classic Microsoft Outlook to be running locally, but no external API keys, SMTP credentials, or 3rd party services. For each recipient, the engine loads the given .oft template, clears any existing 'To' recipients cached in the template file, adds the new recipient address cleanly, then does this prior to sending:

Account assignment: Compels the message to be sent from a particular sending account, via Outlook's MAPI interface. This is how multi-account operation is done; it causes the system to forward each message to the appropriate account in round-robin fashion.

Placeholder replacement: Searches the HTML body of the message for placeholders and substitutes unique values for each recipient. Performs case-insensitive search and replace using regular expressions. Default tokens are: [First name], [Institution Name], [sender name], and [sender mail].

Name processing: Removes all common professional titles (Mr., Ms., Dr., Prof., Sir, Dame, Rev., and so on) from the full name field before it tries to extract the first name for use in the email greeting. A safety rule kicks in here: if the first name extracted is three characters or fewer in length (possibly a parsing problem), the greeting changes from “Dear [First name],” to “Greetings,”.

Send or draft: If in live mode, the email will be sent using mail.Send(). In dry-run mode, it is created as a draft in Outlook, allowing complete visual inspection before sending live.

Status update: At the end of a successful send, the app will open the source CSV file, find the row of the recipient (using email address), and write "Email Sent", the current date, and the sending account address back to the relevant columns, creating a live, self-updating audit trail in the spreadsheet itself.

5.3.3 Interactive Command Interface (main.py)

A step-by-step wizard in the CLI prompts before each batch for sending is run, including confirmation or override of the sending accounts, the maximum number of emails per account, the batch size and interval, and selection of the correct column names given in the CSV headers.

A preview of the first email to be sent, showing the recipient address, resolved first name, institution name, and a line-by-line breakdown of exactly how each placeholder will be substituted, is displayed before a send job is executed for real. This confirmation step is one of the most practically valuable features of the system, as it catches template or data issues before they propagate across an entire batch of hundreds of emails.

5.4 Key Technical Features

5.4.1 Template-Based Personalization

The use of Outlook .oft template files as the basis for the email further means that the system has the benefit of all the HTML formatting, inline images, signature blocks, etc. of a professionally designed corporate email without the automation code needing to generate HTML from the ground up. The placeholder substitution layer simply personalizes on top of that consistent foundation. The effect is an email that is, from the recipient's point of view, indistinguishable from a carefully crafted individual email because it has the same structure, formatting and branding as what Ureka sends manually, with only the personalized content changing.

5.4.2 Batch Sending and Rate Limiting Email

Service providers (ESP) such as corporate Microsoft 365 accounts scan for sending behaviour that mimics bulk mailers or spam. To avoid triggering ESP detection systems, as well as to maintain sender reputation over long campaigns, the system sends in batches, and waits configurable time between batches. The production configuration used throughout my internship is listed in Table 5.1 below.

Parameter	Production Value	Description
Max Emails Per Account	450	Daily ceiling per configured sending account
Batch Size	60 emails	Number of emails to send before each pause
Batch Interval	900 sec (15 min)	Pause duration between consecutive batches
Delay Within Batch	5 seconds	Pause between individual consecutive emails
Dry Run Mode	Disabled (False)	If True, opens drafts rather than sending
Effective Daily Output	~450–500 emails	Per account; multiplied with additional accounts

5.4.3 Multi-Account Round-Robin Distribution

The system can use multiple sending email addresses and it will fan out email to them in a round-robin fashion: each successive email will go to the next account in the list. This can effectively double or triple daily output, but keep each account's volume low enough to be safe. It can also be configured with a distinct display name for each sending account, so the name you are sending as will be the same to the recipient regardless of which sending account a given email was sent through.

5.4.4 CSV Status Tracking and Audit Trail

After each successful send, the system writes back to the source CSV file updating the Status column to "Email Sent", the date and the account the email was sent from. This results in a real time, self-maintaining audit trail that serves two important purposes: it effectively means that a given contact cannot be emailed twice over two separate runs of the system against the same database, but it also provides a clean record of campaign progress which can be filtered, sorted and reported on directly in the spreadsheet with zero additional tooling.

5.4.5 Pause and Resume Functionality

It has a file-based pause/resume capability. If there is a file pause.flag in the system directory the automation pauses and shows a countdown timer before each email and between each batch. If the flag file is removed from another terminal or file explorer window, the run immediately resumes without having to restart it. This has been very handy in long outreach runs when you sometimes need to stop sending temporarily - to change the template, the recipient database, etc. - without losing your place or restarting the batch from the beginning.

5.5 Deployment and Operational Impact

The system was configured on a Windows PC hosting Ureka's Outlook account, and it worked with the in-house CSV contact databases that the company was maintaining for use with the EFI, WOVEN and AIFSI outreach initiatives. In operation, the system would send out on the order of 500 customised emails per day when working with the set-up of configured accounts - an order of magnitude or greater scale increase compared to manual sending, which in practice maxed out at about 40–60 handcrafted emails per day.

Beyond sheer volume, the system also had a significant operational impact. The CSV status tracking removed the most fragile part of large-scale manual outreach accidentally resending to people who had already been reached and batch rate limiting was a safeguard against wasting sender reputation over long-running campaigns. The dry-run preview mode was used regularly before major new campaigns, providing a zero-risk quality check of template personalization before any live emails were sent.

5.6 Key Learnings

The most significant software engineering contribution of my internship was building and deploying that system. It gave rise to a number of lessons that apply well beyond the immediate use case. The most important one was the value of understanding the constraints of the operating environment before designing a solution: the need to use Outlook as opposed to SMTP or a bulk email API informed the entire architecture. Acknowledging and designing around that constraint early resulted in a system that was practical to deploy and genuinely trusted by the team, as opposed to a technically elegant solution that couldn't be used in the actual operating environment.

The experience also reminded me of the business value of clean, defensive software engineering. dry-run mode, the configurable column name mapping, the self-maintaining CSV audit trail, etc., were not things on the initial spec or design document they were all ideas that grew iteratively from the operational needs encountered through usage. Each one made the tool noticeably more robust and trustworthy for the non-developer coworkers who would be using it, and less dependent on the original author being present for each invocation.

CHAPTER 6: SKILLS DEVELOPED AND KEY LEARNINGS

6.1 Overview

The Practice School-II internship at Ureka Education Group was rich in applied learning across diverse professional areas at once. Delivering across 3 programmes with 3 very different target groups - CSR professionals in corporates, decision makers in universities across the world, high profile executives in the fashion industry, and individual students, all while building and deploying a production software system, created a spectrum of on-field exposure hard to simulate in an academic setting. Some of the critical skill areas touched upon are listed in the following sections.

6.2 Software Development for Business Operations

Building the email automation system itself was the project most directly related to my Computer Science background. Regular expression-based text processing, interfacing Python with Outlook's COM interface via win32com, reading and writing CSV files, handling multi-account authentication, and designing a configurable command-line interface (CLI) all involved drawing on skills from different parts of the CS curriculum and using them in a real, production system. This also came with a level of responsibility that more academic projects do not have: non-technical teammates actually use this in their daily work, so system failure or incorrect behavior at scale had immediate, real-world consequences.

6.3 B2B Business Development and Sales

The internship involved direct, practical experience throughout the entire B2B sales development cycle: identifying and building a database of leads, personalizing outreach at scale, and preparing discovery calls, all the way to delivering full programme proposals. The opportunity to build a database of over 1,000 companies for the AI for Social Impact CSR campaign, as well as an international university database of about 3,000 schools for the Ethical Fashion Immersion, gave me a very strong practical foundation in business development that is hard to replicate in the classroom. Making actual discovery calls with big corporate prospects, including Capgemini, Pearson, and Schaeffler, brought the typical B2B sales development cycle to life in a way that reading case studies simply can't.

6.4 Email Marketing and Outreach Copywriting

Writing 200 personalized emails for the CSR project, around 1,500 emails for universities for the EFI, and several additional batches of campaign emails for WOVEN and the university phase of the AIFSI required robust and quickly-developing copywriting abilities. This includes abilities like how to construct engaging email narratives for different segments, how to personalize a pitch at scale, how to write calls to action that work, how to create different language variants that were culturally-adapted (including Portuguese-language emails for South America), and how to adjust the professional "temperature" across a broad spectrum of institutional and corporate recipient types. This process was sped up considerably by the fact that every email had to be seen and approved by Ms. Rand before sending and iterated on as required.

6.5 CRM and KPI Management

A daily KPI dashboard on emails sent, response rates, positive responses, discovery calls booked, and calls completed added pragmatic experience with data-driven decision making and structured reporting to senior stakeholders in a real business context. Reporting pipeline progress weekly to the CEO and Ms. Rand and defending the numbers with explanations of what was driving or constraining progress made concepts like funnel management and conversion rate analysis very real (and not just theoretical).

6.6 Stakeholder Management

Reporting progress on the pipeline project to multiple key senior stakeholders at the same time, getting all of my outreach documents proofread by a professional before use, and reporting on progress during group meetings with Dr. Tojo Mathew instilled good stakeholder management and professional communication skills. The practice of having to go through an approval process for all external correspondence (emails would be proofed before sending) really drilled into me the importance of accuracy, tone, and clarity in a professional environment where your external relationships are on the line every time you send a message.

6.7 Cross-Cultural Communication

Preparing targeted outreach messaging for audiences in the UAE, Europe, South America, South Asia, and Southeast Asia, and drafting complete Portuguese-language email versions for South American university stakeholders in particular, was a hands-on exercise in cultural sensitivity and cross-cultural communication. Following up on discovery calls and written communications with stakeholders at universities in other countries with different educational cultures and institutional conventions also enhanced this expertise, which is in growing demand in the global education field.

CHAPTER 7: CONCLUSIONS AND FUTURE SCOPE

7.1 Conclusions

My Practice School-II internship experience at Ureka Education Group has been nothing short of fulfilling and professionally enlightening. Spanning three interrelated projects and a significant software engineering endeavor, tangible and enduring impact has been made to the organization's business development and participant acquisition efforts.

In **Project 1 (UN AI for Social Impact)**, building a 1,000+ company CSR database to target the world's largest CSR-spending countries; doing 200 tailored outreach emails; and getting positive responses from Capgemini, Schaeffler, and Pearson (both discovery calls completed and full programme proposals delivered) showed the value of a research-informed, ultra-personalized B2B approach. The June 2026 University outreach phase was automated on the system and created over 30 institution responses in a week from institutions in the USA, UK, India, and Europe.

Project 2 (UN Ethical Fashion Immersion) saw a worldwide recruitment drive of around 3,000 universities on 4 continents and resulted in 43 tracked leads, positive discovery call outcomes from ESA Business School (Lebanon), Ashoka University (India) and Krea University (India) and a series of meaningful responses from universities in the UK, Brazil, Italy, Ukraine, Indonesia, and Australia. Rejections have been equally useful, yielding specific and detailed market data about price points and policy issues which are crucial in the design of subsequent campaigns.

A complete outreach strategy was created from the ground up for **Project 3 (WOVEN)**, a brand-new programme, across three channels: re-engaging universities, fashion brand CSR sponsorship and direct outreach to individual students. Discovery calls were secured with Al Zain Jewellery (Kuwait) and Delta Galil (Israel), with substantive engagement - even in cases of eventual declination - with some of the biggest names in fashion including Gucci, Burberry, Ralph Lauren and Brunello Cucinelli. The primary technical project created was a Python email automation system.

The ability to send around 500 customised, templated emails per day, complete with batch rate limiting, multiple accounts round robin, custom placeholder personalisation, and CSV based audit logging, dramatically increased the previous upper bound on the day-to-day output of the outreach efforts. This system remains in production as a live business system past the duration of the internship. For the three projects taken as a whole, the portfolio of 77 tracked institutional and individual responses from organisations representing six continents, is a significant pipeline of business development activity, and one that gives the organisation a tangible and audited base from which to work.

7.2 Future Scope

Several areas exist for further development building on the work completed during this internship:

University Partnership Formalization: The high quality warm leads created through EFI and WOVEN outreach efforts (in particular, ESA Business School and Ashoka University) represent pipeline that, if adequately followed up on, can be moved from initial positive response to signed agreements/partnership letters and ultimately to enrolled students.

Automation System Improvements: Email open and reply tracking would be a natural extension of the current system. A web-based, lightweight dashboard for viewing and tracking campaigns in progress. Automated follow up sequencing based on recipient actions would be a nice feature. Integrating the system with a lightweight CRM or a cloud-based database backend (recipient loading module already has this with the SQLite function) would help scale pipeline management as volume increases.

WOVEN B2C Scale-Up: As a fully online programme at an affordable price-point, the WOVEN programme has significant scalability. The direct outreach to individual fashion students at NIFT/other institutes which we tested as a channel during the internship can be explored as a more systematic Campaign with target Audience personas, Sequencing of messages and Conversion tracking.

CSR Pipeline Progression: Discovery calls with Capgemini, Schaeffler and Pearson for AI for Social Impact programme were real commercial opportunities. Further progression on Capgemini, Schaeffler and Pearson pilot commitment decisions, plus expanding the university CSR outreach pipeline that began in June 2026, could be realised as significant programme revenue.

Analytics Infrastructure: As the program scales, more sophisticated and queryable campaign analytics infrastructure will become a necessity. It would be relatively straightforward to construct a simple analytical layer on top of the current CSV based tracking system (or to shift to a lightweight database backend) to enable proper funnel analysis, benchmarking of response rates by geography / institution type, and other data driven campaign strategy decisions.

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